



Asia
China

Banking / Finance
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Industry

China Banks

Date
15 June 2026

Periodical

May TSF improved sequentially, demand stays weak

May TSF and RMB loans showed sequential improvement, but weak demand persists

May Total Social Financing (TSF) and RMB loans showed weak but sequential improvement. May's monthly TSF and new loan additions came in at RMB2.0tn and RMB520bn, respectively, showing a sequential improvement from April's low base, with both figures slightly higher than consensus. However, the balance growth of TSF and loans decelerated to 7.7% and 5.5%, both reaching historical lows.

TSF in May was RMB2.0tn, rebounding from RMB625bn in April but remaining below RMB2.3tn in May last year. This suggests that real-economy financing demand remains weak across most channels, with the exception of corporate bonds and equity financing, which increased 15% and 95% YoY, respectively.

- **Government bond issuance** slowed to RMB1.2tn in May from RMB1.5tn in April. While government bonds remained the largest contributor to TSF, the slower pace suggests moderate fiscal support compared with the previous month.
- **Corporate bond issuance** increased to RMB172bn, up from RMB150bn in May last year, but declined sequentially from RMB452bn in April.
- **Corporate equity raising** was RMB30bn (up from RMB15bn in April 2026), indicating a sustained momentum of equity capital market activities.
- **Off-balance-sheet financing** remained weak, with trust loans and undiscounted bankers' acceptances continuing to decline, reflecting ongoing deleveraging trends.
- **Other financing** slowed to RMB165bn but remained above the pre-2024 run rate, likely reflecting sustained loan write-offs at an elevated level.

New RMB loans rebounded to RMB520bn in May from a negative RMB10bn in April, suggesting some stabilization in headline credit demand after April's negative print. However, the recovery remains uneven and is still softer than May 2025's RMB620bn.

- **Corporate loans** improved to RMB640bn in May compared to April but declined YoY, driven by a normalization in short-term loans (+RMB100bn versus -RMB460bn in April / RMB110bn in May 2025) and continued bill financing support (+RMB557bn versus RMB75bn in May 2025, but below

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April's RMB1.2tn). Medium-to-long-term corporate loans remained negative at -RMB20bn, indicating that real investment-related credit demand persists as weak. We view the May data as a modest relief from April's weakness, but it demonstrates broadly persistent corporate credit weakness.

- **Household loans** remained negative at -RMB141bn in May, versus -RMB787bn in April. Both short-term loans (-RMB84bn) and medium-to-long-term loans (-RMB57bn) narrowed their declines, suggesting a marginal sequential improvement in consumption and mortgage demand. The medium-to-long-term loans were also impacted by alternative Housing Provident Fund loans, which provide a lower rate than commercial mortgages. That said, continued negative household borrowing points to still-cautious consumer behavior and deleveraging of household balance sheets.

New deposits increased by RMB1.8tn in May, rebounding sharply from RMB270bn in April, though still below RMB2.2tn in May 2025. The increase was mainly supported by non-bank financial institution deposits (+RMB1.1tn) and fiscal deposits (+RMB710bn), while household and corporate deposits remained mildly negative. Household savings declined by RMB110bn in May, narrowing significantly from April's RMB1.9tn drop, but weaker than the RMB470bn increase in May 2025. Corporate deposits also fell modestly by RMB170bn, compared with -RMB1.25tn in April and -RMB418bn in May last year, suggesting some sequential stabilization and marginally improved cash collection and liquidity conditions. Non-bank FI deposits remained the key contributor, though the increase moderated from April's high base of RMB2.5tn, indicating that deposit migration toward wealth management/capital-market-related products is still ongoing but less intense than in April.

May's M1 and M2 growth was 5.5% and 8.6%, respectively. M1 growth improved from 5.0% in April, while M2 stayed broadly stable, pointing to more ample liquidity supported by monetary policy, a modest marginal improvement in transaction-related money demand, and accelerated government spending.

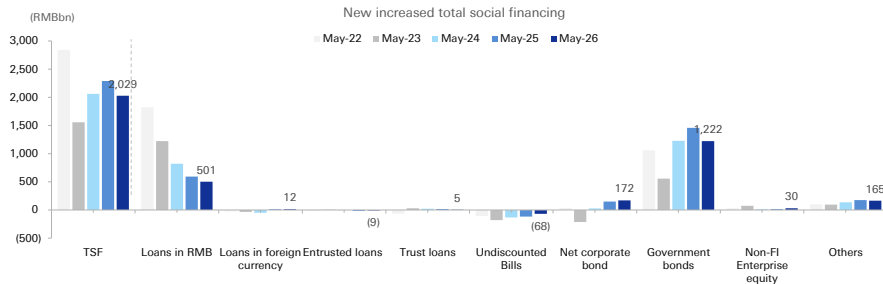
Implication for the banks

Overall, the monthly 11% and 15% decline of TSF and new loans, respectively, imply persistently weak financing demand, following April's trend. Loans, particularly household borrowing, remain weak, while corporate and government financing remain the major contributors. **We stick to our preference for large banks that have larger corporate business exposure, resilient operating performance, and fair dividend yields. Our top picks in the banking sector are CCB-H and BOC-H.**



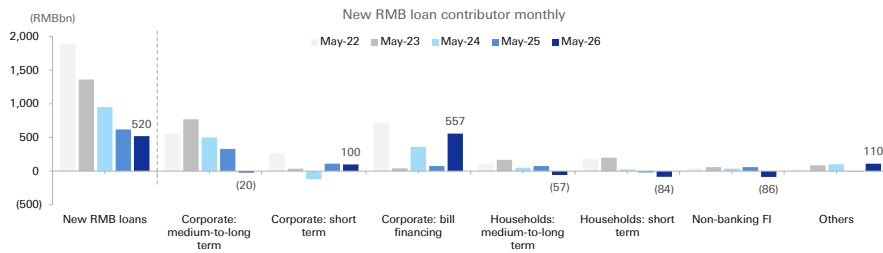
Key charts for the month

Figure 1: New increased TSF - May 2026



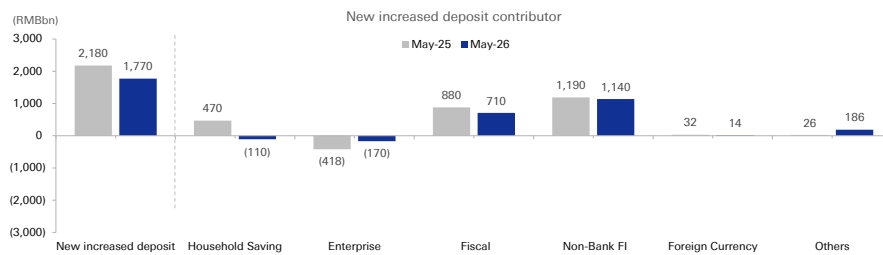
Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank

Figure 2: New increased RMB loans - May 2026



Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank

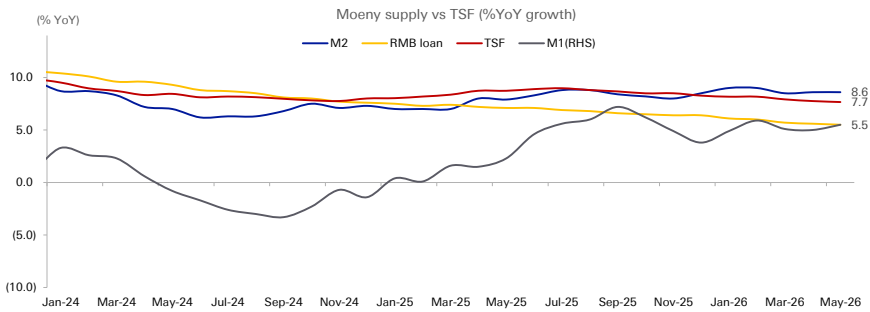
Figure 3: New increased deposit - May 2026



Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank

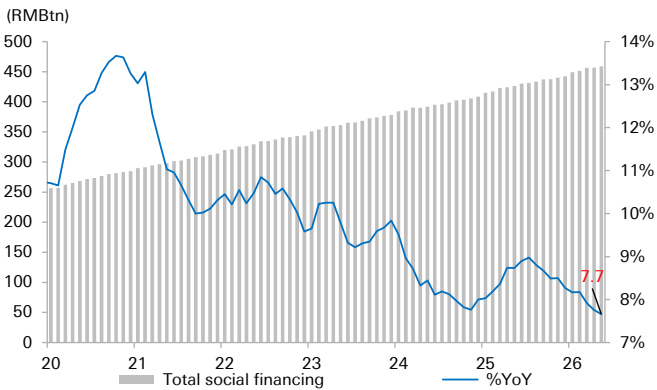


Figure 4: Money supply vs TSF (%YoY growth)



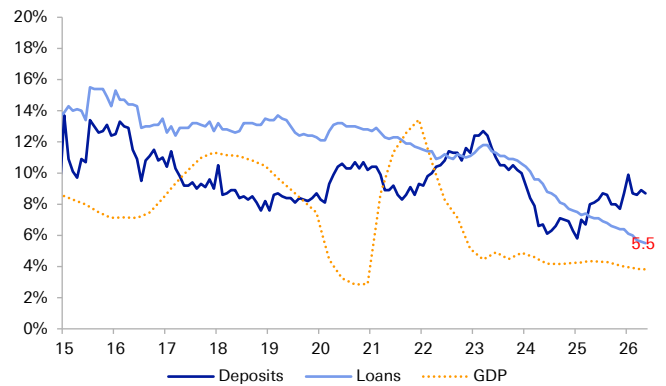
Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank

Figure 5: TSF outstanding and growth



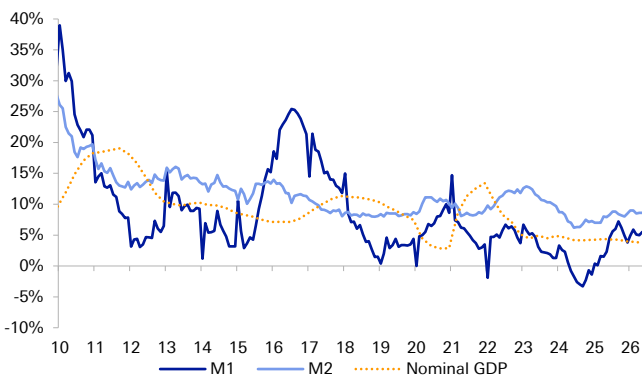
Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank

Figure 6: Loan growth vs. deposit growth



Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank

Figure 7: M1 vs. M2



Source : PBOC, CEIC, Deutsche Bank



Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

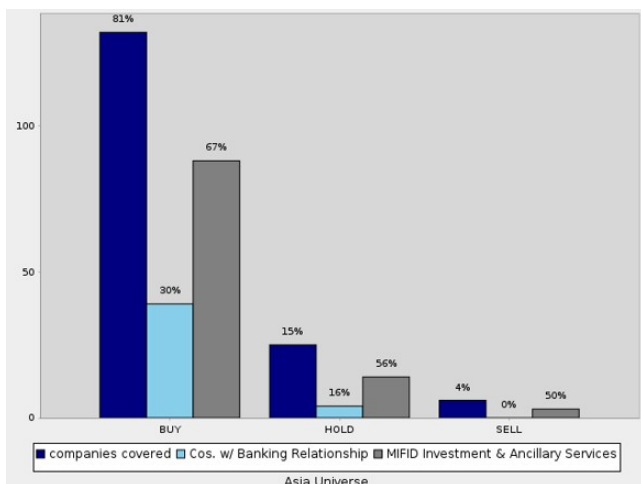
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Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



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